Who am I?

- **Name**: Nikos Vasileiadis
- **Title**: Engineering Leader
- **Location**: Leeds, England, United Kingdom
- **Right to work**: British Citizen

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Top skills

- **Engineering Leadership & Scaling**: Proven track record of building, mentoring, and retaining high-performing remote teams (100% retention rate) while establishing robust Agile practices.
- **Platform & Infrastructure Strategy**: Architecting and managing critical platform services and dependencies with a focus on SLAs, SLIs, and operational excellence for 15+ engineering teams.
- **Design Systems Leadership**: End-to-end experience building and managing Design Systems — from open-source implementation (Pulsar at Jadu) to leading a dedicated Design Systems team at scale, enabling consistent, high-velocity delivery across product and engineering.
- **Agile Transformation & Delivery**: Deep expertise in stepping into complex, low-maturity environments, introducing structured Agile/Scrum methodologies, and driving predictable delivery.
- **Cross-Functional Technical Vision**: Bridging the gap between product strategy, UX, and technical execution, backed by a 20-year foundation in full-stack architecture and digital transformation.

About

I am a strategic engineering leader with over two decades of full-stack experience, now focused on aligning technical infrastructure with business outcomes. Having spent 20 years deep in the code, I now operate at the intersection of product strategy, engineering delivery, and commercial realities. I don't believe in over-engineering for the sake of it; I am a strong advocate for pragmatic, "just right" architecture that solves the actual business problem, scales gracefully, and protects margins.

Commercial Acumen & Financial Literacy: I approach engineering not just as a technical function, but as a lever for business growth. Supported by formal training in "Finance for Non-Financial Managers," CapEx/OpEx budgeting, and business metrics, I actively evaluate vendor ROI and ensure technical investments map directly to company strategy.

Platform Leadership & Risk Management: I manage critical infrastructure services that act as dependencies for 15+ teams. By leading extensive due diligence and audit work—such as replacing legacy CMS platforms—I proactively mitigate risk, ensure operational SLAs/SLOs, and provide the stable foundation upon which the rest of the business builds and scales.

Operational Excellence & Team Retention: I believe that a healthy culture is the ultimate productivity hack. I currently maintain a **100% team retention rate** across my engineering teams, ensuring we deliver predictable, high-quality results even in lean, resource-efficient setups.

Strategic Execution: Currently leading a company-wide rebranding initiative involving 50 distinct components and 460+ pages across two quarters, demonstrating my capability to execute large-scale, cross-functional organizational change.

My 20-year technical foundation—spanning digital strategy, organisational engineering, CMS platforms, modern web architecture, UX, and agile delivery—now serves as a profound strategic advantage. I sit comfortably in the boardroom understanding the financial roadmap, and can seamlessly translate that into a scalable engineering blueprint.

Progressive Leadership Arc (7+ years): My leadership responsibilities have grown continuously since 2017 — from rotating Scrum Master at Jadu, to Interim Scrum Master during a critical digital transformation at Leeds Building Society, to formal Scrum Master at IMA-HOME, to bootstrapping and leading the Content Capability team at Utility Warehouse, to my current Engineering Manager role overseeing two teams and eight engineers. Each step was a deliberate expansion of scope.

I am looking to join a progressive company where I can operate at a high leadership level, utilizing my commercial mindset and technical depth to shape technical strategy, drive business resilience, and lead engineering organizations that actually serve the bottom line. Let's connect.

Experience

Software Engineering Manager

Company: Utility Warehouse
Dates: Jul 2023 - Present (2 yrs 3 mos)
Location: United Kingdom · Remote
Employment Type: Full-time

Responsibilities:

- **Strategic Delivery & Scaling:** Leading a company-wide rebranding initiative across 50 components and 460+ pages, directly managing related CapEx/OpEx budgets, staffing needs, and capacity planning.
- **Platform Architecture & Dependencies:** Architecting and managing critical platform services acting as dependencies for 15+ engineering teams, ensuring high availability and strict SLA/SLO adherence.
- **Design Systems Leadership:** Managed a dedicated Design Systems team — a cross-functional capability enabling consistent, high-velocity delivery across product and engineering. Design Systems work is inherently UX-led and organisation-wide in its reach.
- **Commercial & Vendor Management:** Evaluated CMS solutions, negotiated requirements, and conducted extensive technical due diligence for a legacy CMS replacement to mitigate enterprise risk.
- **Team Topology & Culture:** Built a high-performing engineering culture with a **100% retention rate** across two teams (8 engineers). Optimized team structures to deliver continuous enterprise value, resolving high-level organizational unknowns.
- **Cross-Functional Leadership:** Proactively driving strategic partnerships across marketing, product, and engineering. Acting as the bridge between technical execution and executive roadmaps.

Lead Software Engineer

Company: Utility Warehouse
Dates: May 2022 - Jul 2023 (1 yr 3 mos)
Location: United Kingdom · Remote
Employment Type: Full-time

Description: The Content Capability team was built around me to leverage my cross-functional expertise in engineering, UX, and Agile delivery.

- **Foundational Architecture:** Bootstrapped the core team from the ground up, translating business needs into a scalable engineering blueprint.

- **Strategic Migration Planning:** Conducted rigorous CMS benchmarking, mapped technical debt, and authored the strategy for a large-scale enterprise transition between legacy systems.
- **Process Engineering:** Established robust development lifecycles, definition of done, and workflows that served as the operational foundation for the new team.
- **Talent Development:** Coached and up-skilled engineering talent, functioning as a technical multiplier to elevate the overall capability of the department.

Senior Full Stack Developer & Scrum Master

Company: IMA-HOME
Dates: Jan 2020 - Apr 2022 (2 yrs 4 mos)
Location: Leeds, England, United Kingdom
Employment Type: Full-time, Hybrid

Description: Operated as a dual-threat technical leader for global brands (Adidas, MARS). Alongside architecting frontend solutions, I formally took on Scrum Master responsibilities to elevate the organization's delivery standards and project predictability.

Technical Strategy: Architected and supported scalable, long-term design systems capable of handling high-traffic, global campaigns.

Agile Leadership & Process Engineering: Led as a servant-leader across multiple projects. Redefined "Ways of Working," established rigorous coding best practices, and embedded a mature Agile culture to ensure consistent, high-quality agency output.

Projects: Adidas, MARS, Gregg Wallace, Leeds Rhinos, Royal Canin

Senior Digital Developer

Company: Leeds Building Society
Dates: Oct 2018 - Jan 2020 (1 yr 4 mos)
Location: Leeds, England, United Kingdom · Hybrid
Employment Type: Full-time

Description: Maintained public-facing digital assets in a highly regulated FinTech environment while actively mentoring engineering teams to elevate code quality and UX standards.

Agile Transformation: Introduced Agile and Scrum practices to the organization for the first time. Functioned as the unofficial Agile champion for the majority of my tenure, scaling these processes to improve team delivery.

Leadership in Crisis: Following the successful introduction of Agile workflows, I was formally appointed as Interim Scrum Master (Jun 2019 - Oct 2019) to stabilize delivery and lead a web development team through a critical digital transformation program.

UX Interface Developer

Company: Jadu
Dates: Jan 2017 - Oct 2018 (1 yr 10 mos)
Location: Leeds, England, United Kingdom · Hybrid
Employment Type: Full-time

Description: Designed UIs and developed new features with a strict focus on user experience, accessibility, and W3C standards for an award-winning custom CMS used by Local Authorities, Higher Education, and third-sector organisations.

Design Systems: Co-created and maintained **Pulsar** — an open-source UX and Interface Design System powering the Jadu Continuum Platform. This is the foundation of my Design Systems specialism, combining component architecture, accessibility, and cross-team enablement.

Agile Delivery: Gained foundational, hands-on Agile leadership experience through a rotating Scrum Master model, facilitating sprint planning, daily standups, and embedding the core principles of the Agile manifesto into the team's workflow.

UX Research: Conducted UX interviews, user testing, and research to improve the decision-making process for the design and development teams.

Projects: Award-winning custom CMS for large-scale public sector institutions — Open source Interface Design System (Pulsar)

Digital Developer

Company: DS.Emotion
Dates: Oct 2016 - Nov 2016 (2 months)
Location: Leeds, England, United Kingdom
Employment Type: Contract, On-site

Description: Delivered high-performance frontend solutions for premium real estate and automotive clients (e.g., Silverstone).

- **Performance Optimization**: Spearheaded critical performance optimizations across a portfolio of existing projects, significantly improving load times and user engagement metrics.
- **Workflow Modernization**: Championed the transition to modern deployment lifecycles and structured version control (Git), establishing more reliable and efficient engineering workflows for the agency.

Projects: Silverstone, Bowcliffe Hall, St. Leonard's Place, Woodside Square, Sixteen Real Estate

Front-end Developer

Company: Creode
Dates: Oct 2015 - Sep 2016 (1 year)
Location: Leeds, England, United Kingdom **Employment Type**: Full-time, On-site

Description: Engineered responsive e-commerce solutions for major retail brands (Vivienne Westwood, Kärcher).

- **E-Commerce Delivery**: Collaborated cross-functionally to bring complex UI designs to life, ensuring seamless cross-browser compatibility and strict adherence to brand standards.
- **Digital Marketing Support**: Developed robust architecture for high-conversion HTML email campaigns, directly supporting the agency's retention and sales generation strategies.

Projects: Vivienne Westwood, Kärcher, CACI, EQVVS, G-Type

Early Career & Consulting

Dates: Oct 2005 - Sep 2015 (10 years) **Description**: Various full-stack development, consultancy, and training roles building the foundation of my technical and leadership capabilities. Key experiences included developing CMS-based solutions for non-profits (UNESCO) and local businesses, architecting real estate platforms, engineering e-commerce splits payment systems, and delivering technical training (C Programming, Algorithms).

Education

Institution: freeCodeCamp — Computer Software Engineering

Institution: IxDF - The Interaction Design Foundation — User Experience and Interaction Design (2017–2020)

Institution: International University of Greece - Serres Campus
Degree: BSc Informatics Engineering (attended 2007–2012; did not graduate due to the Greek financial crisis)

Professional Credentials

Team Topologies Distilled · Team Topologies Academy, Oct 2023
Mental Health First Aid Champion · MHFA England & UK Health Security Agency, 2022–2023
Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I) · Scrum.org, Aug 2021
Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) · Scrum.org, Jun 2019

Full certifications list — Scrum, UX, FinTech, analytics, cloud, accessibility, and more — available on the Professional Development page.

Community & Leadership

Mentor, WRK digital *(Feb 2023–Present)*: Peer mentoring network with Engineering Managers, Heads of Engineering, VPs, and CTOs.

Mentor, School of Code *(Aug–Jan 2024)*: Supported early-career engineers entering the industry.

Lead Organiser, Google Developers Group Leeds *(Jan 2019–Mar 2020)*: Revived an inactive GDG chapter; organised conferences, workshops, and technical meetups.